

Climate change

The planet is getting hotter. Oceans, coastal cities, and underwater ecosystems are suffering from the harmful effects of climate change. Global warming is mostly caused by people burning fossil fuels and chopping down forests, which damages the Earth's atmosphere.

Drowning islands

The Funafuti atoll is a ring of islands in the Pacific Ocean. Rising sea levels are causing these islands to sink. Scientists think that Funafuti may completely vanish within the next 50 years.



Waves crashing against Funafuti atoll

Melting glaciers

Since the 1900s, the higher temperatures caused by global warming have made glaciers melt faster than ever before. The extra water has resulted in rising sea levels, more floods, and less ice for animals who depend on it to survive.



Coral bleaching

Warmer water temperatures can cause coral to release crucial algae from their bodies. The coral then turns white in a process called coral bleaching. Over time, coral dies and entire ecosystems can be lost.



Rising sea levels

As huge ice sheets melt, sea levels rise around the world. Coastal cities, such as Miami, in the US, Amsterdam, in the Netherlands, and Shanghai, in China, are at risk of flooding. In the future, the effect of flooding on these areas could be devastating.



Ocean acidification

Oceans are becoming more acidic and less salty because of rising levels of carbon dioxide gas in the Earth's atmosphere. This result of climate change can damage marine ecosystems and be deadly to some sea life.

